

commands in the camera and more. However, there are no major UI changes. The improved battery life is a major plus.

Do remember that the software update will wipe out all the data from your smart watch; so before you check out the update, ensure that you have a backup of your data. Also, you will need to re-pair your device to your Samsung smartphone or tablet. It is possible that with the update, some of the applications might not work, as they were made for Android.

Alcatel to launch 'Made for India' Firefox smartphone soon

If you were waiting for the Firefox-based Alcatel Onetouch Fire to arrive in India, we should tell you that it is not happening, ever! Instead, the company has plans to launch another Firefox OS-based smartphone exclusively made for India.

In a tête-à-tête with EFTimes.com, Piyush A Garg, project manager, APAC, BU India, said, "We will not launch the first Firefox smartphone in India, but we are working on an India-exclusive Firefox-based smartphone. The smartphone will be priced strategically for the Indian market and will be launched by the end of this year."

Garg said that the upcoming Firefox phone will be launched in the budget price bracket and will not be carrier-independent. He said, "Firefox OS needs to grow in India. Considering the fact that Android has such a huge base in India, we are waiting for the right time to launch the Firefox-based smartphones."



Here's the smallest Linux PC you've ever seen!

Mini Linux boards are quite popular amongst the open source community. Raspberry Pi and BeagleBone board are pretty popular in this arena. But these aren't quite as small as a new mini Linux PC known as VoCore. The device may very well be the smallest Linux PC that has ever been made by anyone.

It is reportedly only a coin-sized board that is fitted with a 32 MB SDRAM along with 8 MB of SPI flash memory and a 360 MHz SoC. The PC doesn't have video out capabilities and neither does it have a GPU. This means that the device isn't powerful enough to be used to create a home theatre or for gaming and other such purposes. Moreover, reports suggest that its performance is quite sluggish compared to the Raspberry Pi.

Don't count it out just yet, though. The device has a 10/100 Ethernet along with USB and 802.11n Wi-Fi support. In addition, it is capable of running the OpenWrt, embedded Linux distro and can be used as an ultra portable super VPN router.



Ubuntu community manager Jono Bacon quits Canonical

Looks like it's the summer of surprises for the open source community. After the very recent announcement of openSUSE community manager, Jos Poortvliet, quitting SUSE to join ownCloud, it's now the turn of Ubuntu community manager Jono Bacon to hang up his boots. Jono will now be joining the XPRIZE Foundation as a senior director of community.

Microsoft's Outlook app for Android exposes e-mails to hacking, reports include Security

Security research firm, Include Security, has shockingly revealed that Microsoft's Outlook.com app for Android-based smartphones is prone to exploitation. The fact that it stores email attachments in the file system area of Android OS means these are exposed to any rogue/third party app that has access to users' smartphones. The issue particularly affects users on versions of Android prior to 4.4 (KitKat).

"This app is described as having been created by Seven Networks in conjunction or in association with Microsoft (i.e., it looks as if it was outsourced)," Include Security was quoted as saying in a blog post. On-device email storage has nothing to ensure the privacy of messages and attachments, said the firm. Since emails are stored on the app-specific file system, the PIN code feature of Microsoft's app can protect only the graphical user interface. Evidently, the PIN code feature of the app cannot ensure the privacy of messages on the file system of the smartphone. "We feel users should be aware of cases like this as they often expect their phone's emails to be 'protected' when using mobile messaging applications," the firm added.

Microsoft, on its part, has denied any such privacy concerns being a direct result of its own actions. "We use a variety of security technologies and procedures to help protect your personal information from unauthorised access, use or disclosure," Microsoft was quoted in a statement. "Additionally, customers who wish to encrypt their email can go through their phone settings and encrypt the SD card data," it added.

